

OpenSUSE again

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Windows 8 Portable

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Security watch

levels when it comes to cyber security both in the US and around the world?

Not very good, and let me explain. People in their mid-20s right now would fall into what the demographers would call “the digital native” category. They were born into the digital world that we exist in. I’m in the “digital immigrant” category. I was not born into this world. And most of the policy makers, unfortunately, are older guys like me. They do not have a very good understanding of cyber security, what cyber security is and how to engage their population in cyber security. So we need a vast educational effort of the policy makers.

There was a study that was published here in India about Indian cyber security last year which said that the policy here – as it is with the rest of the world – is very chaotic at this stage. Until the policy makers rethink the problem and can understand it in a much more broad-based and sophisticated manner, the public policies that we’re going to be enacting are probably going to be a little simplistic and ineffective. So that has to change.

What is your opinion of the Indian cyber policy?

Well, India is certainly one of the countries that has been most progressive with respect to cyber policy, particularly on the industrial side. You have organizations like NASSCOM who have done a terrific job with education with respect to cyber security. There is probably less intellectual property theft in India than there is, for example, in the United States. That being said, the amount of cybercrime in India doubled between 2010 and 2011, that’s the last number we have statistics for. India is among the top in the Asian rim countries in terms of web-based attacks. So there’s a growing problem here in India, and the

cyber policy is just beginning to evolve. And right now in India we’re seeing a kind of tension between the old way of thinking – which is to adopt traditional government-centric regulatory policy which isn’t going to work in cyberspace, because things change much too quickly. And, on the other hand, having a self-regulatory organization approach.

From an economic perspective, what do you think is the fallout of NSA’s PRISM programme? Do you see international companies making an exodus out of American companies and US servers?

Well, there clearly has been an effect, it has been documented with some recent statistics that in some parts of the world, China, for example, and Asia, there has been a statistically significant impact on American technology companies coming out of the disclosures that Snowden generated. I think that that’s probably unwarranted. A lot of the technology companies being hurt by this are victims of these Snowden disclosures, but I think that’s going to be a fairly short term blip. As we move forward, what people are going to want to buy are technologies that are efficient, effective and innovative and I think the more of those that come on board, the Snowden disclosures will eventually have less effect, with respect to technologies and technology companies. With respect to government policy, with regard to protecting individual privacy, now that’s a separate matter. I think there may be more staying power to the disclosures on that end.

One of the fallouts we see from these Snowden disclosures is the BRICS Internet coming up, so what are your thoughts about that? And do you see an eventual fracturing of the Internet as a global communication medium where people/nations start having

walled gardens and sub-Internets within the Internet?

I don’t think that’s a long-term solution. The fact of the matter is that we live in a global economy. We are inherently interconnected to each other, and I think the efficiencies of a worldwide Internet are going to overcome any of these issues that have come out of these disclosures. I think that this is another example of policy makers and digital immigrants taking a sort of old world solution, an isolationist solution to a 21st century product. I don’t think it’s going to work, I think they’re going to discover that it’s not going to work and hopefully when they do they will turn their thinking to a much more collaborative, open approach and realize that their nation as well as the community of nations are going to be better off if we work together to create a sustained system of cyber security rather than wall each other off in order to protect ourselves.

The Internet of Things is now a reality. From a cyber security perspective, how do you see this changing the threat landscape which exists right now?

You need to embrace the Internet of Things. And I think that this is a solvable problem. People look at the cyber security problems and say ‘Well, that’s really hard to solve’. And it is. We’ve done much harder things before.

You know, there aren’t schools of Internet philosophy or thought leadership with respect to cyber security. All we have pretty much are these technical orientations, and the technologists are way ahead of the public policy people and the philosophers with respect to this new technology. But eventually we’re going to catch up and merge these two things together so I’m very optimistic about the future and what digitalization is going to create.

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